TASK5: Cybercrime Awareness Case Study & Prevention Guide

Part A – Case Study:

UPI/Online Payment Fraud is a rapidly growing cybercrime where attackers trick users into transferring money or revealing sensitive banking details. This type of fraud commonly targets college students and young adults who frequently use digital payment apps.

A typical scenario begins when a victim receives a call, SMS, or WhatsApp message claiming to be from a bank, delivery service, or even a known contact. The fraudster may create urgency, such as a failed transaction or prize claim. Step-by-step, the attacker sends a fake payment request or a malicious link. The victim is asked to “accept” a collect request or enter details like UPI PIN or OTP. In some cases, fraudsters ask users to install screen-sharing apps, allowing them to access banking apps directly. Once the victim approves the request or shares details, money is instantly transferred from their account.

Students, first-time digital users, and people unfamiliar with UPI security are the most common targets. The consequences include immediate financial loss, emotional distress, and sometimes unauthorized access to linked bank accounts.

This type of fraud highlights the importance of digital awareness. Users must understand that legitimate organizations never ask for PINs or OTPs. Being cautious, verifying requests, and avoiding unknown links are essential steps to prevent such cybercrimes.

Part B – Prevention Checklist:

Stay Safe Online – Prevention Checklist

Actionable Safety Tips

1. Verify links before clicking – Always check the URL of websites, especially before logging in or entering personal details.
2. Use strong, unique passwords – Create passwords with a mix of letters, numbers, and symbols, and avoid using the same password for multiple accounts.
3. Enable Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) – Add an extra layer of security to your email, social media, and banking apps.
4. Avoid public Wi-Fi for sensitive tasks – Do not access banking apps or enter passwords on unsecured public networks.
5. Be cautious of unknown messages/calls – Do not trust calls or messages asking for urgent action or personal details.
6. UPI Safety Tip: Never share your UPI PIN or OTP with anyone, even if they claim to be from your bank.
7. UPI Safety Tip: Always check the receiver's name and UPI ID before approving any payment or collect request.
8. Do not install unknown apps or screen-sharing tools – Fraudsters may use these to gain access to your device and banking apps.
9. Keep your device updated – Regularly update your phone and apps to fix security vulnerabilities.
10. Think before sharing online – Avoid posting sensitive personal information on social media.

Reporting Cybercrime

National Cyber Crime Portal: https://cybercrime.gov.in

Helpline Number: 1930

Conclusion

Following these precautions can help college students stay safe from cyber threats and protect their personal and financial information online.